

Readme file for the replication package of “Endogenous Mobility in Pandemics: Theory and Evidence from the United States” by Chen, Huang, Ju, Sun, and Zhang.

This document describes the data and programs for the paper “Endogenous Mobility in Pandemics: Theory and Evidence from the United States” by Chen, Huang, Ju, Sun, and Zhang. It is organized into three components:

- **Component A (Empirics)**, contains the reduced-form analysis, which generates Figure 1 in Section 1 and the stylized facts in Section 2; and parameter estimation in Section 5.
- **Component B (Simulation)** provides the code to conduct the simulation in Sections 4.
- **Component C (Quantification)** includes the code and data to perform the quantitative analysis in Section 5.

Notes: Please change the directories to your local ones before running the code.

A. Empirics

For Figure 1 from Section 1 and stylized facts from Section 2, see the do file under path “~ \empirics\do ”, with outputs saved under “~ \empirics\results”. Please install the mapping tool “*ssc install geo2xy*” if it is not installed on your Stata.

Run “RegressionTables.do”:

- (1) Generate Figures 1, 2, and 3;
- (2) Generate Tables 1, 2, and B4.

Run “ParameterEstimation.do” to estimate trade costs and mobility elasticity:

- (1) Generate Tables B1, B6 and trade cost parameters.

B. Simulation

For simulation results from Section 4, see the m files under path “~\simulation\Code_Simulation”.

Run “main.m”:

- (1) generates Figure 5 (simulation_dynamics_GE.eps) from the 4-region economy
- (2) generates Figure B.4 (short_effect.eps) from the model with short-run mobility

C. Quantification

%%

For calibration and baseline counterfactual results, see the m files under path "`~\quantification\Benchmark`".¹

First, run "`importdata_high.m`":

- (1) Generate Figure B.1 (a)(b) (`productivity.eps`; `amenity.eps`)
- (2) Generate Figure B.3 (`V_d_fitness.eps`)
- (3) Calibrate the mobility distance elasticity `alpha_1` (stored in variable "`para(2)`") and contiguity barrier `alpha_2` (stored in variable "`para(3)`")
- (4) Calibrate the local containment policy elasticity `nu` (stored in variable "`sol_chi(1)`")
- (5) Calibrate the mobility containment policy elasticity `eta` (stored in variable "`E_PolicyMob`")

Then, run "`main_dynamics.m`":

- (1) Generate Figure B.2 (`Population_fitness.eps`)
- (2) Generate Figure 6 (a)(b) (`Infection_fitness-l.eps`; `Infection_state.eps`)
- (3) Generate Figure 7 (`NewCaseRatio.eps`)
- (4) Generate Table 3

Notes: The welfare and health outcomes saved in the csv file *Benchmark.csv*

%%

For robustness w.r.t. the discount rate `beta`, see the m files under path "`~\quantification\Robust_beta`".

First, run "`importdata_high.m`" with `beta` evaluated at heading section

Then, run "`main_dynamics.m`" with `beta` evaluated at heading section:

- (1) Generate panel (a) of Table B.7

Notes: The welfare and health outcomes saved in the csv file *Counterfactual_RR_beta.csv*

%%

For robustness w.r.t. the inverse mobility elasticity `kappa`, see the m files under path "`~\quantification\Robust_kappa`".

First, run "`importdata_high.m`" with `kappa` evaluated at heading section

¹ Notes: the last digit of the output numbers might fluctuate due to rounding and numerical errors.

For robustness w.r.t. the social cost of death, V_d , see the m files under path " $\sim$ \quantification\Robust_ V_d ".

First, run "importdata_high.m"

Then, run "main_dynamics.m" with V_d evaluated at heading section:

(1) Generate panel (f) of Table B.7

Notes: The welfare and health outcomes saved in the csv file *Counterfactual_RR_ V_d .csv*